

9: Dictionaries

9.1: Dictionaries

A dictionary is like a list, but more general. In a list, the index positions have to be integers; in a dictionary, the indices can be (almost) any type. You can think of a dictionary as a mapping between a set of indices (which are called keys) and a set of values. Each key maps to a value. The association of a key and a value is called a key-value pair or sometimes an item.

9.3: Dictionaries and Files

One of the common uses of a dictionary is to count the occurrence of words in a file with some written text.

9.5: Advanced Text Parsing

9.E: Dictionaries (Exercises)

9.2: Dictionary as a Set of Counters

An implementation is a way of performing a computation; some implementations are better than others. For example, an advantage of the dictionary implementation is that we don't have to know ahead of time which letters appear in the string and we only have to make room for the letters that do appear.

9.4: Looping and Dictionaries

If you use a dictionary as the sequence in a for statement, it traverses the keys of the dictionary.

9.6: Debugging

9.G: Dictionaries (Glossary)

This page titled 9: Dictionaries was last modified on Tue, 01 Dec 2020 03:48:12 GMT and is shared under a [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Chuck Severance](#) via [source content](#) that was edited to the style and standards of the LibreTexts platform.